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Activity 2

Students are divided into groups of three or four and given an earthworm on a damp paper towel. The paper towel should be placed in container so that the worms do not move away. For two minutes, students should observe the worm and record its behavior and morphology. Identify the earthworm's anterior, posterior ends and its external apertures and locate the earthworm's clitellum. Using a battery torch, focus light on the earthworm and observe whether the earthworm moves towards light or away from light. Why? This will be recorded on their lab sheet under "Worm's behaviour and morphology." Students can then watch a short video of an earthworm dissection where the different organs of the worm are labelled and explained. Ask the students to label the different parts of the worm and its anatomy after watching the video. At the end of the lab work, students may be asked to recall about the parts of the worm's body responsible for regulating, signalling, and performing its behaviour.

Earthworm dissection video

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=A2BY 0hRUA9E

In the given diagram using the terms given below, label the parts of the worm:

Mouth, Anus, Brain, Crop, Gizzard, Intestine, Pharynx, Segments, Clitellum, Blood vessels, Hearts, Oesophagus, and Nerve Cord.

